

Contact Information

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Research Interests

Time Series Econometrics, Forecasting, Machine Learning
Applied Microeconometrics, Crime/Urban, Labour

Appointments

2017– Associate Professor, Department of Economics, University of Alberta
2010–17 Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, University of Alberta

Education

2010 Ph.D. Economics, University of Washington
- Dissertation Title: “Unit Root Tests, Structural Change, and Stationary Covariates”
- Committee: Eric Zivot (Chair), Charles Nelson, Chang-Jin Kim, and Richard Startz
2006 M.A. Economics, University of Washington
2003 Licenciado en Economía, Universidad de la República (Uruguay)

Refereed Publications

1. “Exchange Rate Predictability and Financial Conditions”
w/ X. Lu
Empirical Economics, 2026, 71(3), 33 [DOI](#)
2. “Opportunity in Transit: Bus Stop Crowding and Crime”
w/ C. Díaz, F. Fernández, and N. Trajtenberg
Crime Science, 2026, 15(1), 16 [DOI](#)
3. “When ‘Eyes on the Street’ Are Not Enough: Insights from Itinerant Street Markets”
w/ C. Díaz and N. Trajtenberg
Journal of Quantitative Criminology, 2026, 42(1), 141–169 [DOI](#)
4. “The Heterogeneous Effects of COVID-19 Lockdowns on Crime across the World”
w/ N. Trajtenberg, C. Díaz, ..., and M. Eisner
Crime Science, 2024, 13(1), 22 [DOI](#)
5. “First to \$15: Alberta’s Minimum Wage Policy on Employment by Wages, Ages, and Places”
w/ J. Marchand
ILR Review, 2024, 77(1), 119–142 [DOI](#)

6. “Stay at home if you can: COVID-19 stay-at-home guidelines and local crime”
w/ C. Díaz and N. Trajtenberg
Journal of Empirical Legal Studies, 2022, 19(4), 1067–1113 [DOI](#)
7. “Output Growth and Structural Reform in Latin America: Have Business Cycles Changed?”
Contemporary Economic Policy, 2017, 35(1), 62–75 [DOI](#)
8. “Dating US Business Cycles with Macro Factors”
Studies in Nonlinear Dynamics & Econometrics, 2016, 20(5), 529–547 [DOI](#)
9. “Forecasting US Recessions with Macro Factors”
Applied Economics, 2015, 47(53), 5726–5738 [DOI](#)
10. “Unit Root Testing with Stationary Covariates and a Structural Break in the Trend Function”
Journal of Time Series Analysis, 2013, 34(3), 368–384 [DOI](#)
11. “Covariate Unit Root Tests with Good Size and Power”
Computational Statistics & Data Analysis, 2012, 56(11), 3070–3079 [DOI](#)
12. “Regional and International Market Integration of a Small Open Economy”
w/ F. Lorenzo and C.M. Rodríguez
Journal of Applied Economics, 2007, 10(1), 77–98 [DOI](#)

Working Papers / In Progress

1. “A Man Down: The Cost of Punishment in the FIFA World Cup” w/ E. Choque, C. Díaz, F. Fernández, and A. Surco, submitted
2. “Nowcasting in a data-poor environment: A monthly real GDP index for the province of Alberta” w/ A. Pollozhani, submitted
3. “Eyes on the street, threshold dynamics, and property crime” w/ C. Díaz, M. Felson, F. Fernández, and N. Trajtenberg, submitted
4. “Do Opportunity Effects Travel? Replication of Quasi-Experimental Evidence in Two Latin American Cities” w/ C. Díaz, F. Fernández, and N. Trajtenberg, submitted
5. “Unfolding Regional Business Cycles: Factor Models for Three-Way State-Level Tensors”, submitted
6. “Women on the Margins: Gendered Effects of Large Minimum Wage Changes in Canada” w/ J. Marchand
7. “Oil Price Shocks and Real-Time US Output Growth Density Forecasts”
8. “A Test for State-Dependent Predictive Ability based on a Markov-Switching Framework”

Other Publications (non-refereed) / Manuscripts

1. “Integración Internacional de los Mercados Agropecuarios Uruguayos”
w/ F. Lorenzo and C.M. Rodríguez. *ANUARIO 2003 (OPYPA - MGAP)*.
2. “Transmisión de Señales de Precios Internacionales a Precios Domésticos. Un Análisis de la Integración Espacial de los Mercados Agropecuarios Uruguayos”
w/ C.M. Rodríguez. Universidad de la República, Uruguay (2003).

Conference and Seminar Presentations (including scheduled)

- 2026 (1) 9th RCEA Time Series Econometrics Conference, Madrid. (2) 7th Vienna Workshop on High Dimensional Time Series (IHS), Vienna. (3) Pontificia Universidad Javeriana and University of Alberta Virtual Workshop. (4) International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE), Lisbon. (5) Canadian Econometrics Study Group (CESG), Vancouver.
- 2025 (1) European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association, Berlin. (2) Canadian Economics Association Annual Conference, Montreal. (3) 3rd Vienna Workshop on Economic Forecasting (IHS), Vienna. (4) International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE), Torino. (5) Sociedad de Economistas del Uruguay (SEU), Montevideo.
- 2024 (1) Sociedad de Economistas del Uruguay (SEU), Montevideo.
- 2022 (1) University of Manchester, School of Social Sciences. (2) International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE), London. (3) Society for Economic Measurement (SEM), Calgary.
- 2020 (1) Sociedad de Economistas del Uruguay (SEU), Montevideo.
- 2019 (1) Canadian Economics Association Annual Conference, Banff.
- 2018 (1) Society for Nonlinear Dynamics & Econometrics (SNDE), Tokyo. (2) NBER-NSF Time Series Conference, San Diego. (3) University of Houston, Department of Economics. (4) Canadian Econometrics Study Group (CESG), Ottawa. (5) Latin American Meeting of the Econometric Society (LAMES), Guayaquil. (6) NBP Workshop on Forecasting, Warsaw.
- 2017 (1) Sociedad de Economistas del Uruguay (SEU), Montevideo.
- 2016 (1) Society for Nonlinear Dynamics & Econometrics (SNDE), Tuscaloosa. (2) Central Bank of Uruguay. (3) International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE), Milano.
- 2015 (1) International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE), Thessaloniki.
- 2014 (1) Society for Nonlinear Dynamics & Econometrics (SNDE), New York City.
- 2013 (1) Midwest Econometrics Group Meeting, Bloomington. (2) Conferencia: Avances en Economía, Montevideo.
- 2012 (1) Canadian Economics Association Annual Conference, Calgary. (2) Conference in Honor of Charles Nelson, Seattle. (3) Midwest Econometrics Group Meeting, Lexington. (4) Latin American Meeting of the Econometric Society (LAMES), Lima. (5) Encuentro de Economía de Montevideo (Central Bank of Uruguay), Montevideo.
- 2011 (1) Society for Nonlinear Dynamics & Econometrics (SNDE), Washington DC. (2) University of Hawaii, Department of Economics.
- 2010 (1) University of Alberta, Department of Economics. (2) Bank of Canada. (3) Santa Clara University, Leavey School of Business. (4) University of Washington, Foster Business School. (5) Central Bank of Uruguay.
- 2009 (1) ITAM, School of Business. (2) CIDE, Department of Economics. (3) University of Alberta, Alberta School of Business. (4) University of St. Gallen, Department of Economics. (5) Econometric Society European Meeting (ESEM), Barcelona. (6) NBER-NSF Time Series Conference, Davis.
- 2008 (1) Latin American Meeting of the Econometric Society (LAMES), Rio de Janeiro.
- 2003 (1) Latin American Meeting of the Econometric Society (LAMES), Panama City. (2) Jornadas de Economía (Central Bank of Uruguay), Montevideo. (3) International Conference in Economics VII, Ankara. (4) Latin American and Caribbean Economic Association (LACEA) Annual Conference, Puebla.

Grants, Fellowships, and Awards

Research Funding

- **MITACS Accelerate** (research with partner organizations, w/ V. Galvani), 2017–2028
14 awards, \$915,000 total, continuous funding since 2017
PI on 3 awards (\$150,000); co-PI on 11 awards (\$765,000)
Individual awards range from \$30,000 to \$135,000
- ANII (Agencia Nacional de Investigación e Innovación, Uruguay), 2021–22. Fondo Sectorial Seguridad Ciudadana 2020: “Unintended Consequences of Police Surveillance: Lessons from a Domestic and Gender-Based Violence Prevention Program” (w/ C. Díaz and N. Trajtenberg, investigator, approximately \$28,000)
- EFF-SAS Travel Grant, University of Alberta, 2016, 2013, 2011 (3 awards)
- EFF-Special Capital Equipment Fund, University of Alberta, 2011

Fellowships and Awards

- Grover and Creta Ensley Fellowship, University of Washington, 2008–09
- Buechel Memorial Fellowship, University of Washington, 2007–08

Teaching Experience

University of Alberta: Introductory Econometrics (Econ 399), Economic Forecasting (Econ 493), Econometric Methods (Econ 497), Applied Economics Projects II (Econ 504, Graduate), Time Series Econometrics (Econ 509, Graduate), Prediction and Machine Learning for Economics (Econ 593, Graduate), Econometric Theory and Applications (Econ 598, Graduate).

University of Washington: Intermediate Macroeconomics (Econ 301), Econometric Applications (Econ 483).

Student Supervision

PhD Student (role, graduation year, placement)

- Husame Doganay (co-supervisor)
- Xiao Lu (co-supervisor, 2026)
- Moshe Lander (supervisor, Concordia University)
- Max Sties (supervisor, 2017, University of Alberta)
- Waleem Alausa (committee member, 2014, Alberta Pensions Services Corporation)

Service

Department of Economics (University of Alberta)

- Undergraduate Curriculum Committee, 2023–
- Visiting Speakers and Faculty Seminar/Workshop Committee, 2023–
- Computer Services Committee, 2010–17, 2018–
- Advisory Staff Selection (Hiring Committee), 2015–16, 2020–21, 2022–23
- Committee to Review Econ 299, 2015–17
- Graduate Appeals Committee, 2014–15
- Mentoring Committee for Sessional Lecturers (Econ 399), 2014–15

University of Alberta

- Science Faculty Council, 2026–29
- School of Business Faculty Council, 2019–23
- Arts Council for Technology & Innovation (ACTI), 2014–17

External PhD Thesis Examiner

- Yusuke Tsujimoto, PhD in Business, University of Alberta, 2023
- Joseph DeCoste, PhD in Business, University of Alberta, 2022
- Joseph DeCoste, PhD candidacy exam, University of Alberta, 2020
- Bordin Bordeerath, PhD in Business, University of Alberta, 2020
- Yusuke Tsujimoto, PhD candidacy exam, University of Alberta, 2020
- Bordin Bordeerath, PhD candidacy exam, University of Alberta, 2017
- Yue Qiu, PhD in Economics, Queen's University, 2017

Other Professional Activities

Referee

Alberta Law Review, Applied Economics (4), Applied Financial Economics, Canadian Journal of Economics (3), Computational Statistics & Data Analysis, Crime Science, Econometric Reviews, Econometrics, Econometrics and Statistics, Economic Inquiry, Economics Letters (2), Economic Modelling, Empirical Economics, International Journal of Forecasting, Journal of Applied Economics, Journal of Business & Economic Statistics, Journal of Business Cycle Measurement and Analysis, Journal of Forecasting (3), Journal of Statistical Computation and Simulation, Macroeconomic Dynamics, Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics, Studies in Nonlinear Dynamics & Econometrics, The Energy Journal.

Conference Program Committee

- Society for Economic Measurement (SEM), 2022
- Society for Economic Measurement (SEM), 2020 (canceled)
- Latin American Meeting of the Econometric Society (LAMES), 2018
- Sociedad de Economistas del Uruguay (SEU), 2017

Grant Proposal Reviewer

- Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council (SSHRC) Insight Grants, 2023
- Advancing Research and Creativity grant, University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee, 2023
- Comisión Sectorial de Investigación Científica, Universidad de la República (Uruguay), 2020
- Sea Grant College program, University of Hawai'i, 2017

Other Research and Professional Experience

- 2007 Intern at the Portfolio Strategies Group, Russell Investment Group.
- 2006 Research Assistant for Professor Yu-chin Chen, University of Washington.
- 2001 Research Assistant at Arthur Andersen Uruguay (CPA Consultores).
- 2000 Intern at the Department of Monetary Analysis, Central Bank of Uruguay.

Membership, Other Skills, Etc.

Membership: Canadian Economic Association (CEA), Sociedad de Economistas del Uruguay (SEU).

Languages: English, Spanish.

Citizenship: Canada, Uruguay.